DELAY MANAGEMENT STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

General International Airport (fictional)

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This is a fictional document created for training purposes.

Section 1. Definitions

1.1 A flight is delayed when it departs or arrives more than 15 minutes after its scheduled time.

1.2 Every delay longer than 15 minutes must be assigned one reason code: late inbound aircraft, technical, crew, ground handling or weather.

1.3 Cancelled flights are reported separately and are not counted as delayed.

Section 2. Airline performance monitoring

2.1 Operations publishes a punctuality report for every airline each month, showing the percentage of delayed flights.

2.2 An airline with more than 30 percent of flights delayed in a month receives a formal warning from the Airline Relations team.

2.3 An airline above the 30 percent limit for 3 consecutive months is placed under performance review, its incentives are suspended under the Airline Incentive Policy (GIA-POL-02), and its slot allocation may be reviewed.

2.4 Delays coded as ground handling that are caused by the airport count against the airport's own performance indicators, not the airline's.

Section 3. Passenger care during delays

3.1 Delay longer than 60 minutes: the airline must provide clear information at the gate and on the information screens.

3.2 Delay longer than 120 minutes: meal vouchers must be offered to every affected passenger.

3.3 Delay longer than 240 minutes: hotel accommodation must be offered to passengers who cannot continue their journey the same day.

Section 4. Root cause follow-up

4.1 When one airline accounts for the majority of technical or late-inbound delays over 2 consecutive months, Operations must meet the airline and agree a recovery plan within 14 days.

4.2 Recovery plans are reviewed monthly until the airline is below the 30 percent limit for 3 consecutive months.